Northlake University — EEM Suite branding animations (POC)

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PREPARED BY Northlake University

Two production-credible web animations for the EEM Suite portal login + loading experience, themed for **Northlake University** and built to reskin per customer.

- **Login entrance** — the Northlake mark assembles (lake ripples expand, a gold spark settles, the lake horizon draws), then the wordmark rises and a gold underline draws. Targets `.auth-branding__figure`. ~2.2 s, then an optional ambient ripple.
- **Loading** — the generic Kendo ring is replaced by concentric lake ripples pulsing from a gold spark. Overrides `.k-loading-mask .k-loading-image` (56×56), ~1.2 s seamless loop, with a Lottie full-page splash variant.

Open `login-animation.html` and `loading-animation.html` in any browser to preview each (engine toggle, replay, and a reduced-motion preview are built in).

Library & license

Dependency	Used for	License
lottie-web `5.12.x` (CDN)	Login entrance + loading splash JSON playback	**MIT**
Pure CSS / SVG	Loading spinner (in-mask) + login fallback engine	none (zero-dependency)
Spectral, IBM Plex Sans, IBM Plex Mono (Google Fonts)	Wordmark + UI type	**OFL 1.1**

No GSAP / GreenSock. Every moving part is MIT or zero-dependency. lottie-web is loaded once for the whole app; each customer is then just a different `.json`.

> The hand-authored `.json` files here are a working POC. Production JSONs would normally come from a designer (After Effects → Bodymovin, or LottieFiles).

Files & where they go

File	What it is	Drop into
`login-animation.html`	Preview + integration for the login entrance (Lottie **and** CSS/SVG engines)	reference / demo
`loading-animation.html`	Preview + integration for the loading mask + Lottie splash	reference / demo
`northlake-login.json`	Lottie source — login mark assembly (one-shot)	`app/branding/` (served as a static asset)
`northlake-loading.json`	Lottie source — loading ripple loop / splash	`app/branding/`
`loading-animation.less`	**Drop-in LESS** overriding `.k-loading-mask` `.k-loading-image`	**supersedes** `loading-animation.less`
`northlake-theme-vars.css`	The five `--color-*` custom-property overrides (+ optional helpers)	global theme layer / `:root`
`northlake-mark.svg`	Static Northlake mark (reduced-motion / no-JS fallback, favicon-safe)	`app/branding/`

Login entrance — wiring

1. Inside `login/_auth-branding.less`'s `.auth-branding__figure`, replace the static `<img>` with a mark host + caption (see snippet 1 on the page).
2. Mount the Lottie (snippet 2) — `fetch` the JSON and pass it as `animationData`, then add `is-playing` to the figure to drive the caption + underline (snippet 3).
3. Prefer the CSS/SVG engine instead? The same inline SVG + keyframes ship with no runtime — toggle "CSS / SVG" on the page to compare.

Loading — wiring

1. Replace `loading-animation.less` with the provided `loading-animation.less`. It targets the real Kendo selectors, so no markup changes are required; keep the optional `.k-loading-text` element for the caption.
2. For a richer full-page boot splash, use `northlake-loading.json` with the same lottie-web player (snippet 2 on the loading page).

Reduced motion

Every deliverable honours `@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce)`:

- **Login** — animations are **additive**: the composed lockup (mark + wordmark + underline) is the **default** state, so no-JS, slow-connection, and reduced-motion users see the final result with no flash. JS renders the Lottie's **last frame** statically when reduction is requested.
- **Loading** — the ripples and spark stop; the mask holds a calm two-ring static mark plus the caption. The Lottie splash stops on a representative frame.

Both pages include a **"Preview reduced motion"** button so you can verify the fallback without changing OS settings.

Reskin for another customer

The whole system is driven by five theme hooks the EEM app already exposes. To onboard a new customer, change values — not code.

1 · Set the theme vars (`northlake-theme-vars.css`):

```
:root{
  --color-primary:   #14263F;  /* deepest brand tone — gradient base / ink   */
  --color-primary-2: #1F3A5F;  /* brand color — panel + mark                 */
  --color-accent:    #C9A227;  /* highlight — spark, ripples, underline      */
  --color-tertiary:  #2E6E7E;  /* support — secondary ripple                 */
  --font-size-sm:    0.875rem; /* caption / loading text                     */
}
```

The ripples, spark, underline, panel gradient and caption all read these — the CSS/SVG engine and the loading mask reskin instantly.

2 · Swap the mark / motion source:

- **Lottie path** → replace `northlake-login.json` / `northlake-loading.json` (and the colors baked into them). Same player, same markup.
- **CSS/SVG path** → swap `northlake-mark.svg` and the inline `<svg>` in the page's `#nl-css-mark` template; the one hard-coded value is the loading spark's `fill` in the data-URI (one line in `loading-animation.less`).

No JavaScript or keyframe changes are needed for a reskin.

Notes

- Lottie JSONs are loaded via `fetch(...).then(r => r.json())` + `animationData` (rather than lottie's `path:` option) so they work regardless of how the runtime resolves relative URLs in your bundler.
- The mark geometry (navy roundel · gold north-star spark · two gold lake-horizon bars) follows the Northlake University identity; on the navy panel it is shown as a reverse lockup (gold knocked out of navy), so the hard navy disc is omitted.